Begin before the curtain.



Watercolour 1 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Imagine a small theatre with no announced production. Two collaborators arrive with different memories of the same room. Let the first exchange reveal a question rather than announce a finished programme.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What does one character notice that the other overlooks?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A room can establish mood without establishing a plot.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write two opening lines with different priorities.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep both versions; do not vote for a winner yet.

ACT 1 / ARRIVAL

Give the room a point of view.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Begin before the curtain.
2 Give the room a point of view.
3 Let an object ask a question.
4 Start with an incomplete want.
5 Make an entrance meaningful.
6 Choose an opening question.



Watercolour 1 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Describe the auditorium through one imagined character’s attention. A worn seat might suggest familiarity to one person and neglect to another. These are narrative choices, not findings about a real venue.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which detail changes meaning when the observer changes?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

The same visible detail can carry two interpretations.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Rewrite a room description from the second character’s view.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Separate description from a character’s assumption.

02

ACT 1 / 5
BEAT 2 / 6

Let an object ask a question.



Watercolour 2 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Choose a blank notebook, an empty chair or a folded coat. Give it a personal meaning within the invented story. Do not present the illustrated object as a historical artefact or an actual production prop.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What question could a closed notebook leave unanswered?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

An ordinary object can hold a story’s uncertainty.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Invent two incompatible explanations for the object.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Leave one explanation unresolved for a later page.

ACT 1 / ARRIVAL

Start with an incomplete want.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Begin before the curtain.
2 Give the room a point of view.
3 Let an object ask a question.
4 Start with an incomplete want.
5 Make an entrance meaningful.
6 Choose an opening question.



Watercolour 2 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

A character can want to be heard without knowing what to say. Write a modest desire that could change through conversation. Avoid turning a creative exercise into a diagnosis of a real participant.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What would count as a small change for this invented character?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A desire is not the same as a complete plan.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Describe the want in one sentence without naming a trait.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep the character fictional and the stakes bounded.

04

ACT 1 / 5
BEAT 4 / 6

ACT 1 / ARRIVAL

Make an entrance meaningful.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Begin before the curtain.
2 Give the room a point of view.
3 Let an object ask a question.
4 Start with an incomplete want.
5 Make an entrance meaningful.
6 Choose an opening question.



Watercolour 3 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

An arrival can change what people expect from a room. Imagine a late collaborator entering an otherwise quiet conversation. Explore attention and hesitation in prose, not directions for moving real performers.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What expectation shifts when the third voice arrives?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A new voice can alter an exchange without raising its volume.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write the same entrance as welcome and as interruption.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Compare meanings, not physical rehearsal instructions.

Choose an opening question.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Begin before the curtain.
2 Give the room a point of view.
3 Let an object ask a question.
4 Start with an incomplete want.
5 Make an entrance meaningful.
6 Choose an opening question.



Watercolour 3 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Look back at the five opening exercises. Select a question that leaves more than one plausible response. This local choice is a creative note, not a confirmed programme, booking or audience commitment.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which question invites the clearest next scene?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

An opening can promise exploration rather than an answer.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write a one-sentence invitation to the fictional story.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Name the uncertainty you intentionally keep.

Set two versions side by side.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Set two versions side by side.
2 Change the light in the sentence.
3 Let silence have alternatives.
4 Offer a generous disagreement.
5 Test a reversal of expectation.
6 Name what contrast reveals.



Watercolour 4 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

One character remembers a generous room; another remembers a room that never listened. Give each a specific fictional detail. Contrast becomes richer when neither voice is reduced to a slogan.

LEAVE A QUESTION

How can both versions feel internally plausible?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Contrasting memories need not be ranked as measured facts.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write one short memory for each imagined speaker.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep the source of each claim inside the story.

ACT 2 / CONTRAST

Change the light in the sentence.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Set two versions side by side.
2 Change the light in the sentence.
3 Let silence have alternatives.
4 Offer a generous disagreement.
5 Test a reversal of expectation.
6 Name what contrast reveals.



Watercolour 4 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Describe the same lobby first with distant violet evening, then with warm amber lamps. Use language to explore mood. The pictures are visual prompts, not a lighting specification or electrical plan.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What emotional reading changes while the facts stay the same?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Colour can suggest a mood without proving an emotion.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Replace three descriptive words, leaving the action unchanged.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Do not turn a colour association into a universal rule.

ACT 2 / CONTRAST

Let silence have alternatives.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Set two versions side by side.
2 Change the light in the sentence.
3 Let silence have alternatives.
4 Offer a generous disagreement.
5 Test a reversal of expectation.
6 Name what contrast reveals.



Watercolour 5 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

A pause may suggest care, doubt, distraction or refusal within fiction. Write more than one reading before choosing one. No pause in this exercise measures an actual person’s intention.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What else could this fictional silence mean?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Silence does not have one dependable interpretation.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Draft three different thoughts beneath the same unsaid line.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep at least two interpretations available.

ACT 2 / CONTRAST

Offer a generous disagreement.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Set two versions side by side.
2 Change the light in the sentence.
3 Let silence have alternatives.
4 Offer a generous disagreement.
5 Test a reversal of expectation.
6 Name what contrast reveals.



Watercolour 5 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Give two invented collaborators different priorities for a story ending. Let each acknowledge a useful part of the other’s idea. This explores dialogue rather than a procedure for resolving real workplace disputes.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which acknowledgement makes the disagreement more interesting?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A response can recognise value without agreeing.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write a disagreement without using always or never.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep the disagreement about the imagined story.

Test a reversal of expectation.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Set two versions side by side.
2 Change the light in the sentence.
3 Let silence have alternatives.
4 Offer a generous disagreement.
5 Test a reversal of expectation.
6 Name what contrast reveals.



Watercolour 6 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

A character who expected to speak finds a reason to listen. Describe a small fictional event that changes the expectation. Avoid treating surprise as a requirement for every narrative.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What new detail makes the change understandable?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A reversal needs context to feel earned.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write the expected response and one plausible alternative.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Retain the detail connecting both versions.

ACT 2 / CONTRAST

Name what contrast reveals.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Set two versions side by side.
2 Change the light in the sentence.
3 Let silence have alternatives.
4 Offer a generous disagreement.
5 Test a reversal of expectation.
6 Name what contrast reveals.



Watercolour 6 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Review this act’s paired descriptions, memories and responses. Name a tension in ordinary language. A useful creative tension opens possibilities; it does not establish a psychological fact about the people using this template.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What tension could sustain another conversation?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A theme can emerge from specific choices.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write a provisional theme beginning with Perhaps.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Label it provisional, not the project’s approved message.

ACT 3 / MOVEMENT

Move an idea, not a person.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Move an idea, not a person.
2 Use a repeated phrase carefully.
3 Make room for another voice.
4 Let an object return changed.
5 Keep a transition readable.
6 Find the turn without a verdict.



Watercolour 7 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Trace how a thought changes between two lines of dialogue. The movement here is narrative: from certainty to curiosity, or from haste to attention. The folio does not supply physical blocking or accessibility instructions.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which word marks the shift in the imagined exchange?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Narrative movement is a change of understanding.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write two lines in which a confident claim becomes a question.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep the change visible in the language.

ACT 3 / MOVEMENT

Use a repeated phrase carefully.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Move an idea, not a person.
2 Use a repeated phrase carefully.
3 Make room for another voice.
4 Let an object return changed.
5 Keep a transition readable.
6 Find the turn without a verdict.



Watercolour 7 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Give a short phrase a different meaning when it returns. A line such as We can wait may first sound reluctant and later generous. Repetition is an optional writing device, not a guaranteed emotional effect.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What changed around the repeated words?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Context can transform a familiar phrase.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Place the same line in two different fictional exchanges.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep both surrounding contexts available.

ACT 3 / MOVEMENT

Make room for another voice.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Move an idea, not a person.
2 Use a repeated phrase carefully.
3 Make room for another voice.
4 Let an object return changed.
5 Keep a transition readable.
6 Find the turn without a verdict.



Watercolour 8 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Introduce a third imagined perspective without asking it to represent a whole community. Give this character a specific concern and a limited view. A fictional voice is not evidence of real audience needs.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What can this new speaker know, and what can they not know?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

No single fictional speaker represents everyone.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write a concern that belongs to this particular character.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Avoid borrowing real participant details.

ACT 3 / MOVEMENT

Let an object return changed.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Move an idea, not a person.
2 Use a repeated phrase carefully.
3 Make room for another voice.
4 Let an object return changed.
5 Keep a transition readable.
6 Find the turn without a verdict.



Watercolour 8 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Bring back the ordinary object from the opening act. Its physical description can remain the same while a character’s understanding changes. Explore that difference in a short paragraph.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What does the character now understand differently?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A returning object can connect separate moments.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write before and after descriptions of the same notebook.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Preserve the detail that lets readers recognise it.

Keep a transition readable.



Watercolour 9 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Describe what carries the reader from one imagined exchange to the next: a question, a remembered phrase or an unresolved choice. These are reading connections, not a timed running order for a real show.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Why would a reader want to follow this next exchange?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A transition can connect questions rather than locations.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Finish one scene with a question the next scene complicates.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Do not assign invented minutes or technical calls.

ACT 3 / MOVEMENT

Find the turn without a verdict.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Move an idea, not a person.
2 Use a repeated phrase carefully.
3 Make room for another voice.
4 Let an object return changed.
5 Keep a transition readable.
6 Find the turn without a verdict.



Watercolour 9 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Review the changes of understanding in this act. Identify a small turning point, while leaving later consequences open. A turn can be useful without declaring that a character or community has been fixed.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which choice opens the richest set of consequences?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A turn changes possibilities, not necessarily outcomes.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Describe the turn in one sentence and two possible responses.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep the alternatives separate from the chosen draft.

ACT 4 / REVISION

Read a draft as a draft.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Read a draft as a draft.
2 Revise one thing at a time.
3 Distinguish taste from intention.
4 Keep the unused possibility.
5 Return to the story’s boundary.
6 Choose a revision question.



Watercolour 10 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Return to one earlier passage and mark what is clear, ambiguous or missing. These are local creative observations. They are not an official review, performer assessment or permission to produce a show.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which ambiguity is intentional, and which is accidental?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A local mark records a question, not approval.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Use try, revise or park to record your own next step.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep the reason for a mark in the private note.

ACT 4 / REVISION

Revise one thing at a time.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Read a draft as a draft.
2 Revise one thing at a time.
3 Distinguish taste from intention.
4 Keep the unused possibility.
5 Return to the story’s boundary.
6 Choose a revision question.



Watercolour 10 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Choose a single sentence, object detail or reply to change. Compare the before and after versions against a stated creative intention. This is a writing comparison, not a claim that a real audience has responded better.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What change are you actually testing in this draft?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A narrow revision makes comparison easier to explain.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write the intention before changing the sentence.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Retain the earlier version outside this local page if needed.

ACT 4 / REVISION

Distinguish taste from intention.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Read a draft as a draft.
2 Revise one thing at a time.
3 Distinguish taste from intention.
4 Keep the unused possibility.
5 Return to the story’s boundary.
6 Choose a revision question.



Watercolour 11 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

A reader can dislike a choice that still serves the intended story, or enjoy a choice that distracts from it. Note the difference without pretending taste is a measured audience verdict.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Does this note describe preference, clarity or the stated aim?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Different kinds of feedback call for different questions.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Rewrite one vague judgement as a specific creative question.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Do not invent audience survey results.

ACT 4 / REVISION

Keep the unused possibility.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Read a draft as a draft.
2 Revise one thing at a time.
3 Distinguish taste from intention.
4 Keep the unused possibility.
5 Return to the story’s boundary.
6 Choose a revision question.



Watercolour 11 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

A discarded line can remain useful as an alternative. Park it rather than rewriting the project’s history as though only one version existed. Browser-local marks are a convenience, not a version-control system.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What future question might make this version useful again?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

An unused draft is not necessarily a failed draft.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write a brief label explaining why you parked an idea.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Export your record before clearing local storage.

ACT 4 / REVISION

Return to the story’s boundary.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Read a draft as a draft.
2 Revise one thing at a time.
3 Distinguish taste from intention.
4 Keep the unused possibility.
5 Return to the story’s boundary.
6 Choose a revision question.



Watercolour 12 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Check that the imagined exercise still fits its original scope. The folio supplies no venue permissions, participant consent process, technical staging plan or production budget. Those would require separate responsible work.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which question belongs outside this creative folio?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

An evocative illustration is not an operational plan.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Name one creative choice and one separate production question.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Do not record sensitive personal information here.

ACT 4 / REVISION

Choose a revision question.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Read a draft as a draft.

2 Revise one thing at a time.

3 Distinguish taste from intention.

4 Keep the unused possibility.

5 Return to the story’s boundary.

6 Choose a revision question.



Watercolour 12 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Gather the open creative notes without turning them into a promise that the story is ready for a real stage. Choose one question to carry into the handoff act. Keep unresolved alternatives visible.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which question would help another writer respond usefully?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A handoff can be ready for discussion, not for production.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write a question that another reader can answer from the draft.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Name what the reader would need that is not supplied.

ACT 5 / HANDOFF

Introduce the draft honestly.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Introduce the draft honestly.
2 Separate a choice from a promise.
3 Send the version you mean.
4 Leave a useful open question.
5 Keep the workshop fictional.
6 Close with another possibility.



Watercolour 13 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Tell the next reader what this fictional exercise explores and what remains undecided. State that the pictures are illustrations and the beat order is a reading sequence. No actual event or production is announced.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What should the reader know before opening the folio?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Context belongs with the draft, not only in a conversation.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write a two-sentence introduction including one limitation.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep fictional status visible in shared exports.

Separate a choice from a promise.

1 Introduce the draft honestly.
2 Separate a choice from a promise.
3 Send the version you mean.
4 Leave a useful open question.
5 Keep the workshop fictional.
6 Close with another possibility.



Watercolour 13 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

A provisional creative choice is not a booking, contract, funding commitment or accessibility approval. Describe a preferred story direction without implying that real arrangements have been made.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which word could accidentally imply an external commitment?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Creative intention and external permission are different.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Replace a promise with a bounded provisional statement.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Leave operational decisions to a separate real process.

Send the version you mean.



Watercolour 14 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

Current HTML includes your edited text, local marks and private note. JSON records the editable state. Original PDF/PPTX are fixed exports, not automatically revised by this browser.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which export matches the state you intend to share?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Current exports and original downloads are different versions.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Check the title and local mark before exporting.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Do not include private notes you do not intend to share.

Leave a useful open question.

1 Introduce the draft honestly.
2 Separate a choice from a promise.
3 Send the version you mean.
4 Leave a useful open question.
5 Keep the workshop fictional.
6 Close with another possibility.



Watercolour 14 / invented setting and adult characters / not production evidence

STORY INTENTION

A good handoff invites a response without asking the next reader to guess the intention. Connect a specific passage to a specific question, and explain what kind of creative response would help.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What response would help you write the next version?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

A bounded question is easier to answer than Is it good?

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Ask about one moment of clarity or one plausible alternative.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Keep the request about the draft, not the reader’s identity.

ACT 5 / HANDOFF

Keep the workshop fictional.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Introduce the draft honestly.
2 Separate a choice from a promise.
3 Send the version you mean.
4 Leave a useful open question.
5 Keep the workshop fictional.
6 Close with another possibility.

MAIN ART 15 PENDING

A frame for a future illustration.

This typographic placeholder is not a primary artwork. 14 of 15 independent illustrations are present.

Missing main illustration / not counted as completed art

STORY INTENTION

The folio can organise a personal writing exercise, but it does not verify consent, permissions, funding, access or a venue’s readiness. No real participant data is needed in its browser-local notes.

LEAVE A QUESTION

What separate responsible work would a real event require?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

Creative structure is not a real-world approval system.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

State the difference between this exercise and an actual event.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Use no personal identifiers in the exported note.

ACT 5 / HANDOFF

Close with another possibility.

LOCAL / UNMARKED

1 Introduce the draft honestly.
2 Separate a choice from a promise.
3 Send the version you mean.
4 Leave a useful open question.
5 Keep the workshop fictional.
6 Close with another possibility.

MAIN ART 15 PENDING

A frame for a future illustration.

This typographic placeholder is not a primary artwork. 14 of 15 independent illustrations are present.

Missing main illustration / not counted as completed art

STORY INTENTION

A story can close while leaving room for another reading. Keep the question that still interests you. This preview contains fourteen of fifteen independent artworks; the final closing illustration remains explicitly pending, not counted as a completed illustration.

LEAVE A QUESTION

Which possibility deserves the next draft?

Beat order is not timing, a technical call or a show schedule.

01 / NOTICE

The reading order ends; the creative enquiry can continue.

02 / TRY IN WORDS

Write one closing line and a different line you might try later.

03 / KEEP VISIBLE

Preserve the scope, source and current draft status.